



Smooth sailing

Spinosaurus's sail might have had various uses. Some scientists think it was for display or that it acted as a radiator, helping *Spinosaurus* to keep cool in the hot climate. Others think the sail was a hump that stored body fat for energy, as in modern camels.



FAMILY FACT FILE

Key features

- Crocodile-like heads and snouts
- Big conical teeth
- Large sail on back
- Stiff tails, held out for balance

When

Spinosaurids first appeared in the Late Jurassic, 155 million years ago. They died out in the Late Cretaceous, 93 million years ago, when sea levels dropped on Earth and the swamps that spinosaurids lived in dried up.



Baryonyx

bah-ree-ON-ix



- **When** 125 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** British Isles, Spain, Portugal
- **Habitat** Riverbanks
- **Length** 30 ft (9 m)
- **Diet** Fish and meat

Remains of partly digested dinosaurs were found in *Baryonyx*'s fossilized stomach, indicating that it ate land animals as well as fish. It had a very long, low skull, and its jaws had 96 pointed teeth—twice as many as other members of its family. *Baryonyx* may have had a ridge on its back and a small crest on its snout.



▲ CURVED CLAW

Baryonyx means "heavy claw," referring to its huge, hooklike thumb claws, which it may have used to spear fish, as grizzly bears do today.

Nostrils set back from the tip of the snout enabled spinosaurids to breathe while fishing.

